

Newborn Sleep Crib Cry — Action Checklist

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DISTINGUISH CRY TYPES

- **Distinguish Cry Types:** Identify whether your baby's cry is a transfer protest (sharp yelp starting the moment their back hits the mattress) or an actual need cry (sustained, building cry that comes after lying down), because responding to the wrong cry type trains your baby to associate the bassinet with being picked up. Distinguish Cry Types: Listen for whether the cry fades within 30 to 60 seconds with shushing and patting, because a transfer protest triggered by the Moro reflex is reflexive and short-lived, while a genuine need cry will persist or escalate rather than diminish. Distinguish Cry Types: Time the cry onset carefully and avoid assuming every post-transfer cry means your baby needs something, because picking them up every time they cry reinforces the pattern that the bassinet equals distress equals rescue. Distinguish Cry Types: Wait for the protest to resolve on its own before responding, because repeatedly rescuing your baby from the bassinet teaches them that crying is the way to get back into your arms. Prepare the Environment: Swaddle your baby tightly before any transfer attempt to suppress the Moro reflex, because the startle response that wakes them is strongest in unswaddled newborns and the flailing arms make staying asleep impossible. Prepare the Environment: Warm the bassinet mattress with a heating pad or your hands before placing your baby down, because going from your warm body to a cold mattress creates a jarring sensory contrast that can trigger wakefulness. Prepare the Environment: Use white noise at the same volume as your heartbeat and breathing sounds, because maintaining that familiar auditory environment helps your baby believe nothing has changed even after the transfer. Prepare the Environment: Ensure your baby is in deep sleep before attempting the transfer by waiting for limp arms and no eye movement, because attempting the move during light sleep guarantees the position change will wake them. Execute the Transfer: Lower your baby into the bassinet very slowly with their feet touching first, because this staged descent prevents the falling sensation that fires the Moro reflex and causes them to startle awake. Execute the Transfer: Keep one hand on your baby's chest and the other cradling their head for 30 to 60 seconds after they touch the mattress, because removing your hands immediately after placing them down lets them feel the sudden loss of support before they are ready. Execute the Transfer: Shush and pat your baby's chest firmly through any transfer protest without picking them up, because allowing them 30 to 60 seconds to settle teaches them the bassinet is a safe place to stay. Execute the Transfer: Move your body away gradually after the transfer instead of

pulling away immediately, because the sudden loss of your presence directly above them can trigger the panic response that restarts the crying cycle.

☐ **Check the Full Guide:** This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open newborn-sleep-crib-cry_v1.md and review the relevant section.

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PREPARE THE ENVIRONMENT

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EXECUTE THE TRANSFER

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